The Crusades beginning in 1095 **A.C**. went on for over a century and a half. These did not merely represent a struggle between two aggressive religions, a conflict between the Cross and the Crescent. 'The Crusades,' says Professor G. M. Trevelyan, the eminent historian, 'were the military and religious aspect of a general urge towards the east on the part of the reviving energies

of Europe. The prize that Europe brought back from the Crusades **was** not the permanent liberation of the holy Sepulchre or the potential unity of Christendom, of which the story of the Crusades **was** one long negation. She brought back instead the finer arts and crafts, luxury, science, and intellectual curiosity—everything that Peter the Hermit would most have despised.'

Before the last of the Crusades had ingloriously petered out, something cyclonic and cataclysmic had taken place in the heart of Asia. Chengiz (or Jenghiz) Khan had begun his devastating march westward. Born in Mongolia in 1155 A.c., he started on this great march, which was to convert central Asia into a heap of smoking ruins, in 1219. He was no youngster then. Bokhara, Samarkand, Herat, and Balkh, all great cities, each having more